

DRYLANDS SUMMER SCHOOL

2nd Drylands Summer School / Advance to the program

Monitoring Restoration in Agrosilvopastoral Systems for Sustainability and Ecosystem Services

The summer school will take place at the CIFOR-ICRAF Campus in Nairobi, Kenya starting on Wednesday, the 12th of September and finishing on Sunday, the 15th of September. The program will include a field trip.

Learning Objectives:

- 1. Understand Challenges and Solutions for Drylands and Why to Monitor them**
Perform a thorough understanding of the challenges in sustainable land management and restoration initiatives in dryland forests and agrosilvopastoral systems. Analyse the monitoring needs and the different roles involved. Establish a clear link between participation and monitoring.
- 2. Assess and Implement Monitoring Frameworks**
Review available options and choose, adapt, modify and apply a framework for monitoring, evaluating and providing feedback on drylands initiatives.
- 3. Gather Field data and Co-define Indicators for Effective Monitoring**
Develop participatory processes involving local stakeholders to define cross-cutting sets of indicators and gather field data.
- 4. Share Practice, Build Community, and Contribute to Enabling Environments**
Disseminate the monitoring work, provide pathways for improving monitoring in drylands, present and exchange experiences on monitoring drylands, and initiate the building blocks for a long-term community of practice.

Presenters & Experts:

- **FAO Forestry team:** Tiina Vähänen, Thomas Hofer, Marcelo Rezende, Pedro M. Herrera, and Victoria Valenzi
- **CIFOR-ICRAF facilitation team and experts:** Cora van Oosten, Ilse Hennemann, Tor Vågen, Leigh Winowiecki Muhammad Ahmad, Benard Onkware, Christine Magaju .
- **SLU:** Aida Bargués
- **WOCAT:** Lehman Lindeque
- **ARC / 2026 IYRP:** Igshaan Samuels, G20-UNCCD



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Topics per day:

Day 1: Introduction and principles of monitoring drylands • Welcome and opening • Keynote presentation – setting the scene on dryland management • Introduction, principles and practices of monitoring drylands • Monitoring in practice • Getting to know each other • Presentation of individual case studies and action plan • Group work on selected case studies	Day 2: Monitoring frameworks and sustainability indicators • Participatory monitoring • Monitoring frameworks • Use of indicators to monitor drylands initiatives • Group work on selected cases • Individual work on action plan
Day 3: Monitoring in practice • Field trip - TBD	Day 4: Scaling-up from site experience to planet surveillance • Citizen data collection in practice • Scaling-up, from local to global scales • Individual action plan & shared vision • Building blocks for a long-term community • Next steps, evaluation & closing



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COFO (Committee on Forestry)
WORKING
GROUP
on Dryland Forests and
Agroecosystems

